

ENTROPY: THE FIRST LAYER

Level Design Document

ACT 1: INTRODUCTION

PURPOSE

Create a linear environment to introduce the player to the player controller while immersing them in our world narratively. Avoid direct interaction with the Alien while the player is still learning the ropes of the mechanics. Give the player sub-goals/challenges without the Alien to promote using the controller.

MECHANICS

- Tutorial Onboarding
- Zero Gravity Controller
- Manual Lockdown
- Wrist Monitor

DESIGN CHOICES

- Cryochamber no longer has a floor, and funnels the player towards the next area.
- Med bay serves as a location to inform both the player, and ALAN, about the state of the ship.
- Manual Lockdown serves as a way to guide the player in a specific direction, while simultaneously giving the player a task, and purpose in the narrative.
- Having the player need to find their wrist monitor gives the player reason to explore the new areas of the ship that have opened up after the lockdown was lifted.

GAMEPLAY BEATS

- A. Exit your cryopod and complete the tutorial.

- a. **Sound trigger**, every once in a while, the player will be able to hear muffled explosions far off in the ship. Akin to random sounds one would hear in their home late at night. These would serve as perfect ambient sounds for our game, and a way to continuously communicate the danger of the meltdown to the player.
- B. The player moves through a short corridor to the medbay
 - a. **Sound trigger**, ambient sounds of vents rattling as they blow air into the corridor
- C. Enter the med bay, where ALAN will assess the situation that the living quarters have been put on manual lockdown. He instructs you to head to the server room and disable it.
- D. Enter into the living quarters where every path is locked besides the path towards the server room.
 - a. **Sound trigger**, the server room terminal could be playing a simple chime to signify the manual lockdown. An electronic mid-frequency, synthesized beep. This would serve as an auditory beacon that the player will be able to hear and follow to the server room
- E. Enter the server room where a trail of blood remains on the manual lockdown lever.
 - a. **Sound trigger**, the player will be able to hear the alien rustling and murmuring to itself in the vent, creating a sense of anticipation in the player. Who responds with urgency to flip the lever.
- F. The player pulls said lever, disabling the lockdown and giving ALAN control over the living quarters again.
 - a. **Sound trigger**, right after flipping the switch, the lights will all go out, turning the room black. Blanketing it in silence for about 5 seconds. Once that time completes, a loud boot up sequence will begin, startling the player, climaxing the tension built.
 - b. **Sound trigger**, the server room lights up, causing loud computer fans to start blaring with an electric hum crescendoing as the towers boot up again.
 - c. **Sound trigger**, a sound of rustling can be heard from the vent inside of the server room. Not just any ambient rustling, the rustling of the alien scurrying away
- G. Exit out the server room and where the player is now free to explore all paths.
- H. As they enter the junction above the server room, the player can now see access to the escape pod room. The player will enter the junction,

automatically opening this door to reveal a dead body floating in the room. The source of our blood trail.

- a. **Sound trigger**, a slight stinger will play from this encounter, quick and startling. It should convey a feeling of mysterious inquiry. Leaving the player to formulate their own story of how that crew member got themselves into that predicament, given all of the other clues. We have set up to prove that this is the member who put the area on manual lockdown. We now know that they tried to jump ship.
- I. Entering the dining room, ALAN does not allow you exit out into the facilities area without your wrist monitor. He instructs you to get it from your dorm room so he may monitor your activity.
- J. Player backtracks to your dorm and finds the wrist monitor.
- K. Player goes back to the dining hall and exits out into the facilities area.

ENGAGEMENT TIMELINE

1. Learning the mechanics of the game through the tutorial.
2. Enter med bay
 - Door is locked, ALAN assesses the scenario, determining the area has been put on manual lockdown.
 - ALAN directs to go to server room
 - ALAN opens door when dialogue has concluded
3. Broken door to get to server room
4. Reach the manual lockdown lever
 - Blood covered area
 - Vent nearby where you can hear the Alien within.
 - When the lever is flipped all lights activate within the living quarters
 - **Sound trigger:** Alien can be heard scurrying away.
 - ALAN tells player to meet him in the dining hall
5. Exit out of the server room
 - Broken door is fixed
 - Event trigger for when the player begins approaching the junction. When the player gets close, all doors that were previously locked begin to open.
 - Escape pod room opens last, revealing a dead body.
6. Reach dining hall

- ALAN says you need to retrieve your wrist monitor to exit out to the facilities area. He needs this tool to keep track of you while you are not at a terminal.
7. Retrieve wrist monitor
 - Located in your dorm
 - Able to skip the dining hall dialogue if you find the wrist monitor before hand
 8. Return to the dining hall
 - ALAN may have brief dialogue here
 - ALAN opens the door to the facilities

LAYOUT



